In her 1997 memoirs, Antonina Golovina recalled how her family was deported from its ancestral village as kulaks and sent to live in the town of Pestovo. The boys in her new school regularly taunted her. On one occasion, a senior teacher told the eleven-year-old Antonina to stand up in front of all the other children, and began abusing her mercilessly, shouting that 'her sort' were 'enemies of the people, wretched kulaks! You certainly deserved to be deported, I hope you're all exterminated!' Antonina wrote that this was the defining moment of her life. 'I had this feeling in my gut that we [kulaks] were different from the rest, that we were criminals.' She never got over it.[99]

Like the ten-year-old 'witch' Hansel Pappenheimer, the eleven-year-old 'kulak' Antonina Golovina found herself cast into an intersubjective category invented by human mythmakers and imposed by ubiquitous bureaucrats. The mountains of information collected by Soviet bureaucrats about the kulaks weren't the objective truth about them, but they imposed a new intersubjective Soviet truth. Knowing that someone was labelled a kulak was a very important thing to know about a Soviet person, even though the label was entirely bogus.

ONE BIG HAPPY SOVIET FAMILY

The Stalinist regime would go on to attempt something even more ambitious than the mass dismantling of private family farms. It set out to dismantle the family itself. Unlike Roman emperors or Russian tsars, Stalin tried to insert himself even into the most intimate human relationships, coming between parents and children. Family ties were considered the bedrock of corruption, inequality and antiparty activities. Soviet children were therefore taught to worship Stalin as their *real* father and to inform on their biological parents if they criticised Stalin or the Communist Party.

Starting in 1932, the Soviet propaganda machine created a veritable cult around the figure of Pavlik Morozov – a thirteen-year-old boy from the Siberian village of Gerasimovka. In autumn 1931, Pavlik informed the secret police that his father, Trofim – the chairman of the village soviet – was selling false papers to kulak exiles. During the subsequent trial, when Trofim shouted to Pavlik, 'It's me, your father,' the boy retorted, 'Yes, he used to be my father, but I no longer consider him my father.' Trofim was